# Academic verbs and signposts (exam day)

1. Read the article once for meaning. 2. Read it again and look at the **highlighted new words** and the **blue phrases** in context. 3. Study the tables. 4. Use at least 5 new words in speaking or writing this week.

## Article: Reading like an academic: the language of argument (177 words)

Academic writers rarely state facts without comment. They **indicate** a trend, **suggest** a link, or **claim** that something is true, and then **argue** for their position. A careful author will **acknowledge** the limits of the evidence and **emphasize** what remains uncertain. A study may **reveal** a surprising pattern, **establish** a clear cause, or on the contrary **undermine** a popular theory.

Readers must notice how ideas are connected. **However**, **nevertheless** and **whereas** signal a contrast, **furthermore** adds a similar point, and **consequently** shows a result. When a writer says that researchers **assume** something, that is not the same as proof. Words such as **considerable**, **significant** and **approximately** control the strength and precision of a statement: a **significant** difference is not the same as a tiny one, and a result of **approximately** half is not exactly half.

Good readers **read between the lines** and **weigh up** the evidence before they decide. Remember also that many factors **contribute** to any outcome and **contrast** with a single cause. Practice noticing these signals, and True / False / Not Given questions become far easier.

## Useful phrases from the article

| PHRASE | MEANING |
|---|---|
| **read between the lines** | understand what is not said openly |
| **weigh up** | compare |

## The 20 new words

| WORD | | MEANING | EXAMPLE |
|---|---|---|---|
| **indicate** | v | to show or point to | *The graph indicates a steady rise.* |
| **suggest** | v | to put forward an idea | *The study suggests a link.* |
| **claim** | v | to say something is true | *Some experts claim the method works.* |
| **argue** | v | to give reasons for or against | *The author argues for change.* |
| **reveal** | v | to make known | *The results revealed a pattern.* |
| **establish** | v | to prove or set up | *The research established a clear cause.* |
| **assume** | v | to accept as true without proof | *Researchers assumed the data was accurate.* |
| **emphasize** | v | to give special importance | *The writer emphasizes the risks.* |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **contrast** | v | to compare differences | *The article contrasts two methods.* |
| **acknowledge** | v | to accept that something is true | *The author acknowledges the limits.* |
| **undermine** | v | to weaken | *New data undermined the theory.* |
| **contribute** | v | to help cause something | *Poor diet contributes to illness.* |
| **considerable** | adj | large in amount | *There was a considerable increase.* |
| **significant** | adj | important or large enough to notice | *A significant number agreed.* |
| **approximately** | adv | about | *Approximately half agreed.* |
| **however** | adv | used to show contrast | *However, results varied.* |
| **consequently** | adv | as a result | *Consequently, sales fell.* |
| **furthermore** | adv | in addition | *Furthermore, costs rose.* |
| **nevertheless** | adv | in spite of that | *Nevertheless, the plan continued.* |
| **whereas** | conj | used to compare two facts | *The north is dry, whereas the south is wet.* |

## Revision: 10 words from last week

| WORD | | MEANING |
|---|---|---|
| **agriculture** | n | the science and practice of farming |
| **crop** | n | a plant grown for food |
| **harvest** | n | the gathering of ripe crops |
| **livestock** | n | animals kept on a farm |
| **fertilizer** | n | a substance added to soil to help plants grow |
| **irrigation** | n | supplying land with water |
| **organic** | adj | grown without chemicals |
| **genetically modified** | adj | changed by altering genes |
| **famine** | n | a severe shortage of food |
| **nutrient** | n | a substance needed for growth |

## Practice: fill the gaps

furthermore · claim · however · nevertheless · contrast · indicate · contribute · argue

1. _____, costs rose.
2. Some experts _____ the method works.
3. _____, results varied.

4. _____, the plan continued.
5. The article _____ two methods.
6. The graph _____ a steady rise.
7. Poor diet _____ to illness.
8. The author _____ for change.

## More words on this topic (not in the article: choose the 10 most useful for you)

**albeit** (conj): although
**allocate** (v): to give for a purpose
**alternative** (adj): different from the usual
**analyze** (v): to examine in detail
**anticipate** (v): to expect
**attribute** (v): to say something is caused by
**coincide** (v): to happen at the same time
**compile** (v): to collect and put together
**concede** (v): to admit
**conclude** (v): to decide after thought
**conduct** (v): to carry out
**correspond** (v): to match
**demonstrate** (v): to show clearly
**derive** (v): to come from
**distinguish** (v): to see the difference
**elaborate** (v): to give more detail
**estimate** (v): to calculate roughly
**evaluate** (v): to judge the value
**exceed** (v): to go beyond
**imply** (v): to suggest without saying
**infer** (v): to work out from evidence
**interpret** (v): to explain the meaning
**justify** (v): to show as reasonable
**maintain** (v): to continue to say
**obtain** (v): to get
**predominantly** (adv): mainly
**refute** (v): to prove wrong
**substantially** (adv): to a large degree
**whereby** (adv): by which

## Answers

1. Furthermore (furthermore)
2. claim (claim)
3. However (however)
4. Nevertheless (nevertheless)
5. contrasts (contrast)
6. indicates (indicate)
7. contributes (contribute)
8. argues (argue)